Compass

The first gig-economy marketplace for
Community Health Workers.

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1. Mission & Vision

Mission

CompassCHW is a two-sided marketplace that connects certified Community Health Workers with community members who need help navigating housing, food, addiction recovery, mental health, and healthcare systems through a flexible work model that makes community health work accessible, scalable, and financially sustainable for workers.

Vision

A world where every community member has affordable, on-demand access to a trusted health navigator and every Community Health Worker can build a sustainable livelihood through flexible, dignified work.

2. The Problem

2.1 Community members cannot navigate fragmented systems

Social determinants of health — housing, food, addiction, mental health — are addressed by thousands of disconnected community-based organizations (CBOs) and government programs. Community members, especially Medicaid-eligible populations, lack a single point of entry.

CityBlock Health proves the demand exists: they achieve an industry-leading 81% engagement rate by assigning dedicated human navigators (Community Health Partners) to each member. But their W-2 employment model costs $63K-$102K per navigator and currently serves only 10 states. The relationship works. The economics don't scale.

2.2 No gig-economy platform exists for CHWs

The gig economy has transformed rideshare (Uber), food delivery (DoorDash), and clinical staffing (CareRev, ShiftKey) — but Community Health Workers have been left out entirely.

Platform	What it does	CHW gig model?
CareRev / ShiftKey	Gig shifts for nurses and CNAs	No — wrong worker segment
CityBlock Health	Employs Community Health Partners	No — traditional W-2 employment
Pear Suite	CHW enablement and billing	No —enables billing for existing org-employed CHWs; no worker-facing marketplace or matching
UniteUs	Referral network connecting CBOs	No — organization-level, not worker-level

> **The gap is wide open. No platform lets a certified CHW log in, see community demand, and accept work on their own terms.**

2.3 Billing infrastructure exists but isn't worker-centric

California Medi-Cal reimburses CHW services at $26.66/unit (1 unit = 30 min, triggerable at 15 min), up to 4 units per member per day and 10 units per member per year. This creates a $266.60/year billing ceiling per member-relationship which means a W-2 employment model is structurally inefficient. CHWs need member volume, not time depth. CompassCHW's matching engine is the direct structural answer to this billing reality.

- **UniteUs** has a Payments product for CBO-level reimbursement (EDI 837 claims)
- **Pear Suite** enables Medicaid billing for CHW services and takes 15% through its provider network

But nobody has built worker-facing gig tooling on top of these rails. The money is flowing to organizations, not directly empowering individual CHWs.

3. The Solution

Compass combines the best elements of three proven models into something none of them offer alone:

Capability	Inspiration	Compass Adaptation
Network infrastructure & referral coordination	UniteUs (1,600+ orgs, 44 states, $1.6B valuation)	Routes community members to CHWs who know their local CBO networks
Deep community engagement via navigators	CityBlock Health (81% engagement, $5.7B valuation)	Delivers the CHP relationship through gig workers, not W-2 employees
Behavioral incentives for engagement	Wellth (90-95% adherence rates, $79.5M raised)	Applies incentive design to BOTH sides: CHWs and community members

> **Compass is the first platform to combine gig-economy labor dynamics, Medicaid-reimbursable CHW services, and behavioral incentive mechanics into a single two-sided marketplace.**

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Phase 1 billing proxies through Pear Suite for immediate California Medi-Cal reimbursement at $26.66/unit. Phase 2 builds proprietary EDI 837 infrastructure to capture the full margin. ECM-tier services ($386 PMPM) are a Phase 2+ unlock, contingent on TENA completing ECM provider enrollment with LA Care, Molina, Health Net, and ILS/Kaiser.

4. Competitive Landscape

Company	Model	CHW Focus	Gig?	Billing	Gap Compass Fills
UniteUs	B2B SaaS referral	No — org-level	No	CBO reimb. (EDI 837)	No CHW tools or billing
CityBlock	Full-risk capitation	Yes — W-2 CHPs	No	Health plan contracts	Delivers the same trusted navigator relationship at gig-worker economics, scalable to all 50 states
Wellth	Patient incentives	No — patient only	No	SaaS to health plans	No workforce component
Pear Suite	CHW enablement	Yes — 2,500+ workers	No	15% of Medicaid	No marketplace/matching
CareRev/ShiftKey	Clinical gig	No — nurses/CNAs	Yes	Facility billing	Wrong worker segment
Compass	CHW marketplace	Yes — gig CHWs	Yes!	phase 1: Pear Suite API. Phase 2: proprietary EDI 837	First CHW gig marketplace

Defensibility

- **Network effects:** More CHWs attract more community members and vice versa — classic two-sided marketplace moat.
- **Data moat:** Session outcomes, engagement patterns, and CHW performance ratings create proprietary intelligence.
- **Regulatory positioning:** Early mover in states with CHW Medicaid billing; built-in compliance from day one.

5. Platform Architecture

```
Community Member (Web/iOS)  <-->  Compass Platform  <-->  CHW (Web/iOS)
         |                              |                      |
   [Onboarding]                 [Matching Engine]        [Availability]
   [Need Configuration]        [Session Management]     [Credentialing]
   [Feedback & Ratings]        [Billing Engine]         [Earnings/Payouts]
   [Engagement Rewards]        [Incentive Engine]       [Performance Dash]
                                [Analytics Dashboard]
                                     |         |
                              [Pear Suite API]  [Medicaid State APIs]
```

Core Components

- **Matching Engine —** Pairs community members with CHWs based on need type, language, location, availability, and member-configured preferences.
- **Session Management —** Tracks the full session lifecycle: request → accept → in-progress → completed → follow-up.
- **Billing Engine —** Phase 1: proxies through Pear Suite for Medicaid claims. Phase 2: direct EDI 837 submission.
- **CHW Credentialing —** Verifies certifications, background checks, and ongoing compliance.
- **Incentive Engine —** Manages behavioral incentive mechanics for both CHWs and community members.
- **Analytics Dashboard —** Tracks engagement rates, session outcomes, CHW performance, and platform health.

Technical Stack

- **Web app (ships first):** TypeScript/React, strict mode, Zod validation, responsive mobile-first design.
- **iOS app (parallel):** Swift/SwiftUI, async/await, SPM dependencies.
- **Backend:** Python/FastAPI, pydantic data models, async architecture.
- **Shared API layer:** Ensures feature parity — web and iOS stay in sync through a single backend.
- **Infrastructure:** Cloud-native, event-driven matching, HIPAA-compliant hosting.

6. Service Verticals

Compass launches with five core service areas — the most urgent social determinants of health:

1. Housing Assistance

Emergency shelter navigation, transitional housing, rental assistance programs, eviction prevention. CHW activities: identify available programs, assist with applications, accompany to appointments, follow up on status.

2. Rehab & Addiction Recovery

Substance use disorder navigation, treatment facility connections, recovery support networks. CHW activities: connect to treatment programs, provide peer support, arrange transportation to intake, ongoing recovery check-ins.

3. Food & Pantry Navigation

Food bank connections, SNAP/WIC enrollment assistance, community nutrition programs. CHW activities: locate pantries, assist with benefit applications, arrange food delivery or transportation.

4. Mental Health Support

Counseling referrals, crisis navigation, support group connections, therapy access. CHW activities: screen for needs, connect to providers, warm handoffs to behavioral health specialists, follow-up engagement.

5. Healthcare Navigation

Insurance enrollment, primary care matching, appointment scheduling, health literacy education. CHW activities: explain benefits, help with enrollment paperwork, accompany to appointments, translate medical information.

CHWs self-select their specializations during onboarding. Community members filter by need. Many members have overlapping needs — the platform supports multi-vertical sessions and referral chains.

7. CHW Experience

Onboarding & Credentialing

- Upload CHW certification documentation (state-specific)
- Complete background check (integrated third-party provider)
- Build profile: specializations (from 5 verticals), languages spoken, geographic coverage, availability windows
- Enroll through Pear Suite for Medicaid billing eligibility

The Gig Model (How Matching Works)

- CHW opens the app and toggles status to "Available"
- Incoming requests appear filtered by: geographic proximity, vertical match, language match, member preferences, CHW rating
- CHW reviews anonymized request details: need description, estimated session length, session mode (in-person / virtual / phone)
- CHW accepts or passes — passed requests route to next-best match
- Unlike pure Uber-style transactional matching, Compass allows CHWs to maintain ongoing relationships with specific community members (recurring sessions)

Session Execution

- In-app session tracking: start time, session notes, resource referrals logged, end time
- Structured documentation that maps directly to Medicaid billing requirements (service type, duration, outcome codes)
- Real-time local resource directory lookup during sessions

Earnings & Payouts

Earnings & Payouts

Medi-Cal reimburses CHW services at $26.66/unit (1 unit = 30 min, triggerable at 15 min), up to 4 units per member per day and 10 units per member per year. To grow earnings, a CHW must grow their member panel the matching engine makes this possible.

Scenario	Units/day	Gross/day	Net/day P1	Net/day P2
Light (2 members × 1 unit)	2	$53.32	$38.54	$43.98
Moderate (4 members × 2 units)	8	$213.28	$154.16	$175.94
Full (6 members × 3 units)	18	$479.88	$346.86	$395.91
Max daily (5 members × 4 units)	20	$533.20	$385.40	$439.89

P1 = Phase 1 (Pear Suite, midpoint fee). P2 = Phase 2 (direct billing, midpoint fee). Annual billing cap per member: $266.60 gross (10 units × $26.66).

- Transparent per-session earnings displayed before accepting a request
- Weekly direct deposit (initially via Pear Suite disbursement, later direct)
- Earnings dashboard: session history, pending claims, projected income

Incentives (Wellth Model, Adapted for Workers)

- **Availability streaks:** Bonuses for consistent weekly availability.
- **Quality bonuses:** Higher ratings and positive outcomes unlock priority matching.
- **Specialization incentives:** Bonus pay for underserved verticals or geographies with high demand.
- **Milestone rewards:** Recognition and bonuses at session count thresholds.

Design principle: incentivize consistency and quality, not just volume.

8. Community Member Experience

Onboarding

- Minimal friction: name, zip code, primary need (from 5 verticals), preferred language
- No insurance information required upfront — billing is on the CHW side through Pear Suite
- Optional: insurance details for enhanced matching, demographic info
- Privacy-first, HIPAA-compliant data handling from day one

Need Configuration & Filtering

- Select primary need vertical(s)
- Preference filters: CHW gender preference, language, in-person vs. virtual, availability windows
- Urgency indicator: routine / soon (within 48 hours) / urgent (same-day)
- Brief description of what they need help with (free text, optional)

Matching & Sessions

- Platform presents a matched CHW with profile summary: name, photo, specializations, rating, languages
- Member confirms or requests another match
- Session modes: in-person (CHW comes to the member), virtual (video/audio), phone
- Post-session: brief outcome survey (3-5 questions), option to schedule follow-up

Engagement Incentives (Wellth Model, Adapted for Members)

- **Follow-through rewards:** Earn credits for completing referral actions (attending a scheduled appointment, submitting a benefit application).
- **Loss-aversion mechanic:** Small monthly engagement credit that decreases with missed follow-ups (modeled on Wellth's $30/month with $2 daily deductions).

Credits redeemable for: transportation vouchers, grocery gift cards, phone minutes — things that address immediate needs.

9. COST

10. Billing & Revenue

Phase 1: Pear Suite Integration (Launch)

Compass routes completed session documentation to Pear Suite's billing platform. Pear Suite submits Medicaid claims through its Pear Cares Provider Network.

Revenue split at $26.66/unit (Medi-Cal CA rate):

- Medicaid pays: $26.66
- Pear Suite takes 15%: – $4.00
- CompassCHW takes 10–15%: – $2.67–$4.00
- CHW receives: $18.66–$20.00/unit

Advantage: immediate billing capability without building claims infrastructure.
Tradeoff: margin compression from double intermediary fees.

Phase 2: Proprietary Billing (Month 12+)

Revenue split at $26.66/unit (Phase 2 — direct billing):

- **Medicaid pays: $26.66**
- **Pear Suite: $0.00**
- **CompassCHW takes 15–20%: – $4.00–$5.33**
- **CHW receives: $21.33–$22.66/unit**

This is the primary margin expansion lever. CHW take-home improves by ~$4.00/unit — a meaningful recruiting advantage.

Phase 2+: ECM Services

Enhanced Care Management (ECM) contracts at $386 PMPM represent a step-change in revenue per member. This is a Phase 2+ unlock, contingent on TENA completing ECM provider enrollment with LA Care, Molina, Health Net, and ILS/Kaiser. TENA's existing ECM infrastructure and MCP relationships serve as the anchor contract pathway.

Future Revenue Streams

- **Health plan contracts:** Sell outcomes data and engagement analytics to Medicaid MCOs (modeled on UniteUs B2B SaaS).
- **Employer-sponsored plans:** Companies purchase Compass access for employees (EAP-adjacent).
- **Training & certification:** Compass-branded CHW training programs (revenue + supply-side growth).

11. Technology Roadmap

Phase 0: Foundation (Months 1-3)

- Repository and project structure established
- HIPAA compliance framework selected and implemented
- Design system and wireframes (JT/CDO leads)
- Pear Suite API integration scoped and prototyped
- Web app scaffolding: React frontend + FastAPI backend
- CHW onboarding and community member request flows designed

Phase 1: Los Angeles Pilot (Months 3-6)

- Medi-Cal market — California has established CHW Medicaid billing provisions
- Responsive web app for both CHWs and community members
- Basic matching engine (geographic + vertical + language)
- Session tracking and structured documentation
- Pear Suite billing integration live; iOS begins in parallel
- Target: 20-50 CHWs, 100-500 completed sessions

Phase 2: Product-Market Fit (Months 6-12)

- iOS app launch
- Advanced matching: preference filtering, rating-weighted ranking, availability optimization
- Incentive engines for CHWs (streaks, bonuses) and community members (follow-through rewards)
- Analytics dashboard for founders and operations
- Expand to 2-3 additional cities

Phase 3: Scale (Months 12-24)

- Proprietary Medicaid billing infrastructure (replace Pear Suite dependency)
- EHR integration exploration (Epic SMART on FHIR, following UniteUs's pattern)
- Health plan partnership pipeline (B2B revenue stream)
- Multi-state expansion targeting states with established CHW Medicaid billing

Phase 4: Platform (Month 24+)

- Open API for CBO and partner integrations
- Employer-sponsored plans
- Outcomes-based contracting with health plans
- National scale

12. Key Metrics

Supply Side (CHW)

- CHW sign-up and credentialing completion rate
- Weekly active CHWs (available at least once per week)
- Average sessions per CHW per week
- CHW retention at 30 / 60 / 90 days
- Average CHW earnings per week
- CHW Net Promoter Score

Demand Side (Community Members)

- Registration rate
- Request-to-match rate (% of requests resulting in a matched CHW)
- Match-to-session rate (% of matches where session occurs)
- Session completion rate
- Follow-through rate (% of referrals acted upon)
- Engagement rate (target: CityBlock's 81%)
- Community member NPS

Business

- Total sessions per week/month
- Gross Marketplace Value (total Medicaid billing through platform)
- Platform take rate (effective %)
- Revenue per session
- Billing claim success rate
- Time from session completion to CHW payout
- Unit economics: CAC and LTV for both CHWs and community members

Pilot Success Thresholds (Phase 1 — LA)

- 20+ active CHWs
- 50+ completed sessions per month
- 80%+ billing claim success rate
- 60%+ CHW 30-day retention
- 70%+ match-to-session rate

13. Team

Name	Role	Focus Areas
Akram Mahmoud	Co-Founder & CTO	Product, Engineering, Platform Architecture
Jemal Hussein	Co-Founder & CEO	Strategy, Operations, Partnerships
John Thomas (JT)	Co-Founder & CDO	Design, User Experience, Brand

MVP Must have

- CHW and Community member Onboarding
    - V1 done
- Reward system
- Matching system CHW<->member
- Billing
    - Collect requirements for Pear Suite
        - Documentation of interaction
        - Care plan created (goals)
        - Consent from community member approving medical billing, here is an example of language we can use:
            - *"CHW services are provided to you at no cost by your health plan, do you consent to receive services?"*
        - Calls to be recorded if service provided is via a phone call
        - CHW certification, HIPPA, Background check, and CHW continued education upload section
- Profile
    - V1 done

Billing codes:

Diagnose codes- CHW needs to pick one or more of these in order for the claim to process.

Z71.89	Other specified counseling, wellness visits
Z59.12	Utility Insecurity
Z72.3	Lack of physical exercise
Z75.3	Unavailability and inaccessibility of health-care facilities
Z59.00	Living Situation, unspecified
Z59.89	Other problems related to housing and economic circumstances
Z55.6	Problems related to health literacy
Z59.9	Problem related to housing and economic circumstances, unspecified
Z59.86 (Archived)	Financial insecurity
Z65.3	Problems related to other legal circumstances

Procedure and Modifiers*

98960 U2 - CHW Service 1 Person - 1 person

98960 U2 - CHW Service 1 Person - 1 person

98961 U2 - CHW Service 2-4 People - 2-4 people

98962 U2 - CHW Service 5-8 People - 5-8 people

Cancel

Update Activity